- *QuestDB (https://github.com/bluestreak01/questdb)*—A high-performance, open source SQL database for applications from financial services to observability. It includes endpoints for PostgreSQL wire protocol; high-throughput, schema-agnostic ingestion, using InfluxDB Line Protocol; and a REST API for queries, bulk imports, and exports.
- *Zabbix (https://github.com/zabbix/zabbix)*—An open source distributed monitoring solution. Like others in this list (Nagios, Icinga, and OpenTSDB come to mind), it is not widely used today in cloud-native setups, but you should be aware of it.

Some of the open source projects are packaged and offered as services. Let us move on to this topic now.

5.3.3 Commercial offerings for metrics backends

There are a few offerings dedicated to metrics, including the following:

- *Chronosphere (https://chronosphere.io/)*—Essentially "M3DB as a service." They make good progress in terms of features and OpenTelemetry compatibility.
- *VictoriaMetrics (https://github.com/VictoriaMetrics/VictoriaMetrics)*—A monitoring solution with integrated TSDB that you can use standalone or as a service. While Prometheus compliance (https://github.com/prometheus/compliance) is, at time of writing, a growth area for VictoriaMetrics, the overall offering is cloud native and powerful.

In most, if not all, cases (Kubernetes, ECS), you want and need metrics and, with them, a backend. Choose your backend based on Prometheus compatibility and your specific usage pattern (e.g., ingest, storage, or query distribution).

5.4 Backend destinations for traces

Now, we have a look at various options to ingest and query distributed traces. In this space, you would typically find wide support for OpenTelemetry, although Zipkin support is still needed in some places, such as PHP.

5.4.1 Cloud providers

Just as with logs and metrics, your cloud provider of choice has something to offer if you want to ingest and use tracing:

- *AWS X-Ray (https://aws.amazon.com/xray/)*—Amazon's managed distributed-tracing offering, which allows you to analyze and debug applications. It used to be a standalone service and is now being integrated in CloudWatch. X-Ray has standardized on OpenTelemetry and captures traces from a number of compute and database AWS services as well as apps written in Java, Node.js, and .NET.
- *Distributed tracing in Azure (http://mng.bz/zXWw)*—Part of Application Insights with SDKs for .NET, Java, and Node.js/JavaScript. Application Insights now also supports distributed tracing via OpenTelemetry.